



Maiden Castle hill-fort in Britain underwent several phases of rebuilding after it was begun around 600 BCE, reaching its final form about 500 years later.



Captured in stone

The Danzante carvings at Monte Alban, Mexico, were once thought to be of dancers, but they are now believed to represent the mutilated bodies of enemies captured in war.

by beginning **civil service examinations**. Official positions for academics had been established in 136 BCE, consolidating the ruling house's stranglehold on the intellectual life of China. In 106 BCE, **Wudi** appointed **13 regional inspectors** to monitor the behavior of government officials, raised taxes, and forbade private coin-minting. His armies pushed deep into Central Asia. By 108 BCE, the Han Empire had reached its **largest extent**.

In **Mexico**, the population of **Monte Albán** had reached about 17,000 by around 100 BCE. Monte Albán's control began to reach beyond the immediate vicinity of the **Valley of Oaxaca**, and many large stone platforms and public monuments were built in the city.

AFTER HIS VICTORY AT VERCELLAE, (see 110–91 BCE) Marius became Rome's dominant politician, but the brutal behavior of his ally Saturninus, tribune of the plebs, provoked the Senate. **Political violence** flared, and in 100 BCE Marius had to march an army into Rome. Saturninus was killed in the ensuing riot. As Marius's power waned, discontent rose among Italians without Roman citizenship. In 91 BCE, this erupted into the **Social War**. A protégé of Marius, **Lucius Sulla** (c. 138–78 BCE), took a key role in suppressing the revolt, which was **largely over by 88 BCE**, albeit with some concessions offered by Rome to the rebels.

Sulla was elected consul in 88 BCE. That same year, while waiting to sail with his army to Greece to counter the threat posed by the king of Pontus, **Mithridates VI** (134–63 BCE), Sulla heard that the

Senate had voted to put Marius in charge of the campaign. Enraged, Sulla entered Rome with his troops and seized power. He moved against Mithridates in 89 BCE, and had driven him out of Greece by 84 BCE. Sulla returned to Rome, defeated his remaining opponents (including the aged Marius), and was **appointed dictator** in 82 BCE.

Sulla took savage revenge on the Marians, packed the Senate with his supporters, and curtailed the powers of the tribunes. Anti-Sullan forces regrouped around **Quintus Sertorius**, who had fled to Spain. After Sulla died in 78 BCE, the Senate sent **Pompey** to deal with Sertorius. His military efforts were ineffective; only the assassination of Sertorius allowed Pompey to return victorious to Italy in 71 BCE.

In 73 BCE, a **slave revolt** led by the gladiator **Spartacus** broke out near Naples and grew into the most serious revolt Rome had ever faced. Eventually, the rebel slaves were trapped in southern Italy and defeated by the Roman general **Marcus Licinius Crassus** in 71 BCE.

By the 1st century BCE, the Celtic peoples of southern Britain had started to expand their existing **hill-forts** into *oppida* ("towns") that were defended by extensive fortifications. The greatest *oppida* were formidable obstacles to attackers and some were royal capitals, complete with palaces.

70,000

SPARTACAN REBELS

6,000

spartacan rebels crucified

The rebellion by Spartacus

Crassus crucified slaves along the Appian Way, which led to Rome, as a warning to any others who might plan a similar insurrection.

Sacred offering

This 1st-century BCE British Celtic shield was discovered in the Thames River, where it had probably been thrown as an offering to a river god.



c. 100 BCE Celtic hill-forts spread in northwest Europe

100 BCE Political violence flares in Rome

c. 100 BCE Rise of Aksum (Northeast Africa)

99 BCE Serious uprising in eastern China

91 BCE Social War breaks out in Rome (to 89 BCE)

88 BCE Mithridates VI of Pontus attacks the Roman province of Asia

88 BCE Ctesiphon becomes capital of Parthia

88 BCE Roman consul Sulla conducts a savage purge of his pro-Marian opponents

88 BCE Sulla invades Greece and besieges Athens

88 BCE Mithridates II of Parthia is killed by Scythian invaders

86 BCE Marius's army takes control of Rome

84 BCE Roman war with Mithridates VI ends

82 BCE Sulla instigates new purges in Rome

80 BCE Early campaigns of Julius Caesar in Asia

78 BCE Pompey suppresses revolt by the Roman consul Lepidus

74 BCE Bithynia (in Anatolia) becomes Roman province

73 BCE Romans occupy Pontus and Mithridates VI flees to Armenia

72 BCE Sertorius murdered

73 BCE Spartacan slave revolt begins; ends with defeat by Crassus in 71 BCE